

In the hunt

Tiger Woods shoots 67 on 1st day, only 1 shot back as he tries for record 5th straight Bay Hill Invitational victory. **Page B3**



SPORTS

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Friday,
March 19,
2004



TODAY ON TV

TIME: 12:20 p.m.
WHO: Illinois vs. Murray State
WHERE: Value City Arena, Columbus

TIME: 2:45 p.m.
WHO: Cincinnati vs. E. Tennessee St.
WHERE: Value City Arena, Columbus

TIME: 7:10 p.m.
WHO: Wisconsin vs. Richmond
WHERE: Bradley Center, Milwaukee

TIME: 9:40 p.m.
WHO: Xavier vs. Louisville
WHERE: TD Waterhouse Center, Orlando, Fla.

All games on Ch. 19

THURSDAY'S SCORES

• St. Joseph's 82, Liberty 63
• Alabama 65, So. Illinois 64

COMMENTARY

Nelson soars, lifts St. Joe's

Bill Lyon
Knight Ridder Newspapers

BUFFALO, N.Y. — First was a pull-up jumper, sweet as spring rain. Then a 3-ball from the corner, soft as a baby duck's bonom. Followed by two free throws, each one stroked like a thousand violins. And finally a fadeaway from the left wing, the defender left in a tangled mess of helplessness while the ball was falling through like a feather on a spider web. With that one elegant burst, Jameer Nelson of St. Joseph's, roundball virtuoso, grabbed a game by the throat and made it his.

After those four possessions, it was 9-1 Hawks over game but overmatched Liberty University in the opening round of the NCAA eliminations, and Nelson had made it forcefully clear that there would be no

See NELSON, B5



Saint Joseph's Jameer Nelson is fouled by Liberty's Jason Sarchet as Calbe Martin (5) looks on Thursday during the first half of the top-seeded Hawks' 82-63 first-round victory.

'Upset' made in Manhattan

Flores' 26 power Jaspers by Gators

Eddie Pells
The Associated Press

RALEIGH, N.C. — The little team from the Big Apple was every bit as good as promised. Led by 26 points from hotshot guard Luis Flores, 12th-seeded Manhattan defeated fifth-seeded Florida 75-60 in the first round of the NCAA Tournament Thursday — an "upset" that really wasn't much of an upset at all.

"I know America's going to look at it as an upset, but behind closed doors we don't," Manhattan forward Dave Holmes said. "We know we can play with any

team on any night." Barely beaten in the first round last year by eventual champion Syracuse, Manhattan (25-9) won its first tournament game since defeating Oklahoma in 1995. The Jaspers advanced to play Wake Forest, a 79-78 winner over Virginia Commonwealth, in the second round of the East Rutherford Regional. Clearly, the Demon Deacons will have their hands full.

Couch Bobby Gonzalez, celebrating his 40th birthday, insisted there was no way his Jaspers — who play in 2,500-seat Draddy Gymnasium that's actually in the Bronx — would feel overwhelmed in the big tournament against a big-time team from

JASPERS, B4

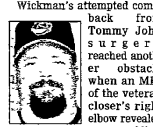
INDIANS

Ailing elbow derails return

Wickman out until mid-July

Chris Assenheimer
The Chronicle-Telegram

WINTER HAVEN, Fla. — Optimism turned to disappointment for Bob Wickman and the Indians on Thursday.



Wickman

Wickman's attempted comeback from Tommy John surgery reached another obstacle when an MRI of the veteran closer's right elbow revealed a sprained ligament that will sideline him until at least the All-Star break.

Wickman complained of soreness in the elbow after pitching an inning during a simulated game at Chain of Lakes Park on Monday. Team doctors prescribed the MRI as a precautionary exam, believing the discomfort was natural for after surgery. It was more than that.

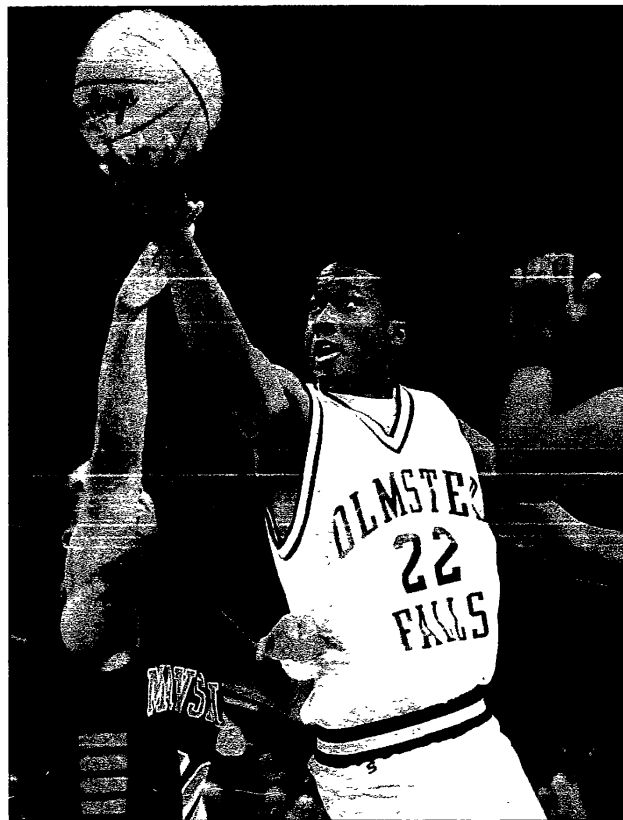
"It's disappointing because I know how hard I worked and how good it felt for so long," said Wickman, who had surgery in December 2002 and has been rehabilitating since. "But my body is telling me to take a break and step back from it. It's disappointing because I feel like I'm letting (head trainer Lonnie Soloff and director of rehabilitation Jim Mehalik) down, and I'm thinking I'm letting the organization down. I don't even think about myself at all in this thing."

The Indians do.

"I feel equally bad for him personally, because I know what kind of commitment he made to the process," said

See TRIBE, B3

Falls follows its stars



Jamar Scales goes to the hoop Thursday during Olmsted Falls' 68-57 regional semifinal victory over Mansfield Senior.

Bulldogs' Big Three lead way into Elite 8

Roger Negin
The Chronicle-Telegram

TOLEDO — With the game on the line and the ultimate prize in sight, Olmsted Falls has some big-time weapons ready for use.

Steve Gansey, Dan Binggeli and Jamar Scales have been leading this basketball program for the biggest part of three basketball seasons and Thursday they were the ones who stepped to the forefront as the Bulldogs beat Mansfield Senior 68-57 in the Division I regional semifinals at Savage Hall.

The trio combined for 64 of Falls' 68 points and hit 23 of 44 shots.

"These guys have played together for so long, especially Dan and Steve," said Falls' coach Pat Donahue. "When Jamar came, he fit right in. All our players lean on them. They are three who can handle the ball, penetrate, shoot and play defense. When you get to this level, you have to rely on your best players."

The Bulldogs (22-2) will be back Saturday to play for a shot at their first berth in the state's Final Four. This is Falls' first time in the regional finals since 1997 when it lost to Cleveland Benedictine on this floor in Division II. Falls will play Toledo St. John's, a 60-47 winner over Rhodes.

"These guys want to keep playing," Donahue said. "We hope to achieve the ultimate goal on Saturday. It's been a goal of ours. We'll see if we're up to it."

"Since seventh or eighth grade we've talked about going to Columbus," said Gansey, who scored 21 points and played virtually the entire game. "We've talked about it

See FALLS, B2

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